

Stage Netherlands + Spain behind a 90-day pilot

NLD + ESP has the strongest floor across defined cases

Floor €43,994 / year

Base €166,931 / year

Stress €107,630 / year

Capex €270,000 • 6 FTE

Board action

Approve a 90-day reversible pilot and staged capex envelope. Release full investment only after measured savings and incremental volume clear the operating gates. Defer remains a valid outcome.

2025 contribution describes the baseline, not hub causality

Sales and margin vary across markets; option economics depend on local volume response and avoidable fulfillment savings.

Country	Orders	Units	Net sales	Contribution	Margin
Germany	209	12,153	€625,792	€262,366	41.9%
France	209	11,880	€632,231	€276,271	43.7%
Netherlands	209	12,576	€697,733	€315,644	45.2%
Poland	209	13,163	€761,890	€356,494	46.8%
Czechia	209	13,733	€815,307	€397,335	48.7%
Spain	209	13,931	€850,839	€421,900	49.6%

No lead-time, lost-sales, customer-interview or controlled service-hub evidence was supplied. Historical shipped mix is not proof of incremental demand from a local hub.

The leading feasible alternatives trade modeled return for resilience

Annual incremental contribution after recurring fixed cost; capex is separate year-zero investment.

Option	Capex yr 0	Fixed / yr	FTE	Base / yr	Stress / yr	Payback
NLD + ESP	€270,000	€120,000	6	€166,931	€107,630	1.6 years
CZE + ESP	€225,000	€95,000	5	€198,099	€32,180	1.1 years
POL + ESP	€240,000	€100,000	6	€186,329	€29,264	1.3 years
POL + CZE	€205,000	€85,000	5	€178,995	€-78,570	1.1 years

Stress is the client policy’s joint refund and FX shock, not a probability forecast. Recommendation uses the highest minimum across low/base/high/stress; CZE + ESP is the leading base-only alternative.

Market context helps locate scale, not product demand

Archived official World Bank population and current-USD GDP/capita, 2022–2024; snapshot vintage 27 Sep 2026.

Country	Population change 2022–24	GDP/capita 2024
Germany	0.4%	\$56,104
France	0.5%	\$46,103
Netherlands	1.7%	\$67,465
Poland	-0.7%	\$25,104
Czechia	2.2%	\$31,828
Spain	2.2%	\$35,327

GDP/capita is current USD, not PPP or constant-price income. Population and GDP do not establish Meridian product demand.

Use staged gates to turn assumptions into evidence

Days 0–15	COO + Finance	Reconcile baseline; validate avoidable cost, cohort and KPI definitions.	Gate: auditable baseline
Days 16–35	Operations + Data	Costed design, pilot zone/SKUs, staffing, legal and inventory dependencies.	Gate: budget and controls
Days 36–65	Country + Supply Chain	Reversible limited-SKU pilot; matched baseline and weekly operating data.	Gate: ≥4 usable weeks
Days 66–90	CFO + COO + Board	Update scenarios, stress and quotes; release, reconfigure or defer.	Gate: positive base economics

Weekly: incremental units/orders, return rate, contribution after returns, avoidable EUR/unit, OTIF, P90 delivery, fill rate, stock accuracy, capex and FTE.

Reopen the choice on measured unit economics

What changes the choice

- Volume response below modeled 10–40%
- Savings prove not avoidable
- Fixed costs exceed quotes
- Return stress erodes contribution
- Pilot misses service or stock gates
- Capex/FTE exceed board caps

Risk controls

- Matched pilot before lift claims
- Validate savings against invoices
- Track cash FX separately from booked revenue
- Limit initial SKU scope
- Monitor restocked share and stock accuracy
- Defer or reconfigure if downside is not accepted

Appendix: model boundaries and reproducibility

Synthetic inputs: order extracts, revisions/corrections, returns, unit costs, hub options and scenario policy from the frozen source room.

Public inputs: archived World Bank population and GDP/capita plus ECB daily reference rates, with URLs, timestamps, hashes, units and periods in sources/source-register.json.

Reproduce: python3 analysis/build.py; python3 analysis/render_pdfs.py. Workbook has 72 monthly results, country totals, 24 PLN/CZK FX means, market context, all hub scenarios and feasible combinations.

Limits: one synthetic baseline year; monthly ECB translation is not transaction FX; no causal lift, probability distributions, ramp, discounting, synergy, tax, working capital or site/legal quotes. Public archive may contain later revisions.